



More than just a FLUSH in the pan



Ancient toilets

Early toilets were basically *open-air holes* in the ground, such as this Roman lavatory from the 2nd century CE. Over the centuries, **SEWAGE SYSTEMS** developed for waste to flow into and be carried away. There were simple forms of the flush toilet in many **ancient civilizations**, including China, Egypt, Persia (modern-day Iran), and Greece.

Royal flush

Centuries passed and *chamber pots* were all the rage. A pot was placed under the bed for regular use, with the smelly contents often tossed out of the window! **JOHN HARRINGTON**, godson to Queen Elizabeth I of England, invented a more advanced flushing toilet in the 1590s, which let water out of a tank and down a pipe to clean the bowl. He installed one for **the queen**, who wasn't impressed, and the invention didn't catch on.



By the way...
I wrote a book full of toilet humor about my invention. My godmother, the queen, was so upset she banished me!

It paved the way for...



The first **TOILET PAPER** went on sale in 1857, though the earliest use was probably in China during the 14th century.



The first **PUBLIC BATHROOM** with flushing toilets opened in London in the **1850s**. Today's public toilets are usually housed in separate cubicles with locks.

The user lifts the D-shaped handle to open the water supply and flush the pan.

